



◀ CRUISE SHIPS

Ocean liners were once the only way for people to travel between continents. Today, airlines have made global travel much quicker, but the ships have been reinvented as giant floating hotels, taking tourists on cruises to exotic destinations such as Tahiti and Antarctica. However, ships use a huge amount of fuel per passenger, because unlike bulk freight, people do not weigh much compared to the ship itself.

SAILING TO ADVENTURE



Yachting is a major leisure activity, with many people owning their own boats. It gives them an opportunity to enjoy the beauty of the sea, and a chance to rely on their own skills in an age when our urban lives offer few real challenges.



▲ COASTAL RESORTS

Millions of people flock to coastal resorts each year to spend time on the beach and enjoy the sea. Since the expansion of air travel, tourism has become a major industry on many once-remote islands, such as Mauritius in the Indian Ocean, seen here. The income of such islands now relies heavily on tourism, but developments designed to attract tourists often cause environmental problems.



◀ EXPLORING THE SEA

Since its invention in the 1940s, scuba diving has become an increasingly popular way of exploring the undersea world. The coral reefs of the Red Sea, Maldives, Micronesia, and Australia are big attractions for divers, and small coral islands such as the Maldives rely on divers for much of their tourist income. Other coastal resorts offer people the chance to dive with dolphins or whales, or even experience thrilling encounters with great white sharks.